



LME KNITTING PATTERN

🇳🇴 NORWAY KERCHIEF 🇳🇴

TRIANGLE KERCHIEF · FLAG FRONT OR BACK

A red kerchief that matches the hat. It is a triangle with a wavy edge, flag stripes and a Norwegian flag. Two ties fasten at the back of the neck. Easy to knit, and lovely for the 17th of May and the football World Cup.

Two versions in one pattern: you choose whether the flag sits at the front (over the forehead) or the back (down near the point). The rest is knitted exactly the same.

By **Renate Dahl**

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



TIP: Read the whole pattern through once first. Knit a little gauge swatch, so the kerchief comes out the right size.

BEFORE YOU START

A kerchief is easy to knit. You start at the point with just a few stitches. Then you increase little by little, until the triangle is big enough. Around the whole kerchief you make a wavy edge with flag stripes. If you like, you also knit in a flag in the middle. At the end you make two ties to fasten with.

WHAT YOU LEARN

- To knit a triangle
- To increase stitches at the sides
- To knit in a flag in two colours (optional)
- To make a tie (I-cord)
- To make a wavy edge

IS IT HARD?

Beginner. If you can cast on, knit and increase, you can do this. Everything else is given step by step. Ask a grown-up if you get stuck.

HOW TO READ THE NUMBERS

The kerchief comes in two sizes. The numbers are written like this:

child (adult)

For a child use the first number. For an adult use the number in brackets.

One step at a time. And it becomes a kerchief in the end.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

DROPS Paris (100% cotton). A thick, soft cotton yarn. You knit on 5 mm needles.

Colour	Child	Adult
● Red	1 ball	2 balls
○ White	1 ball	1 ball
● Navy blue	1 ball	1 ball

ALSO THIS

- A **5 mm circular needle** (it is long, so there is room for many stitches)
- Two **5 mm double-pointed needles** for the ties
- A **stitch marker** (or a little loop of yarn)
- A **tapestry needle** with a blunt tip
- Scissors

GAUGE SWATCH

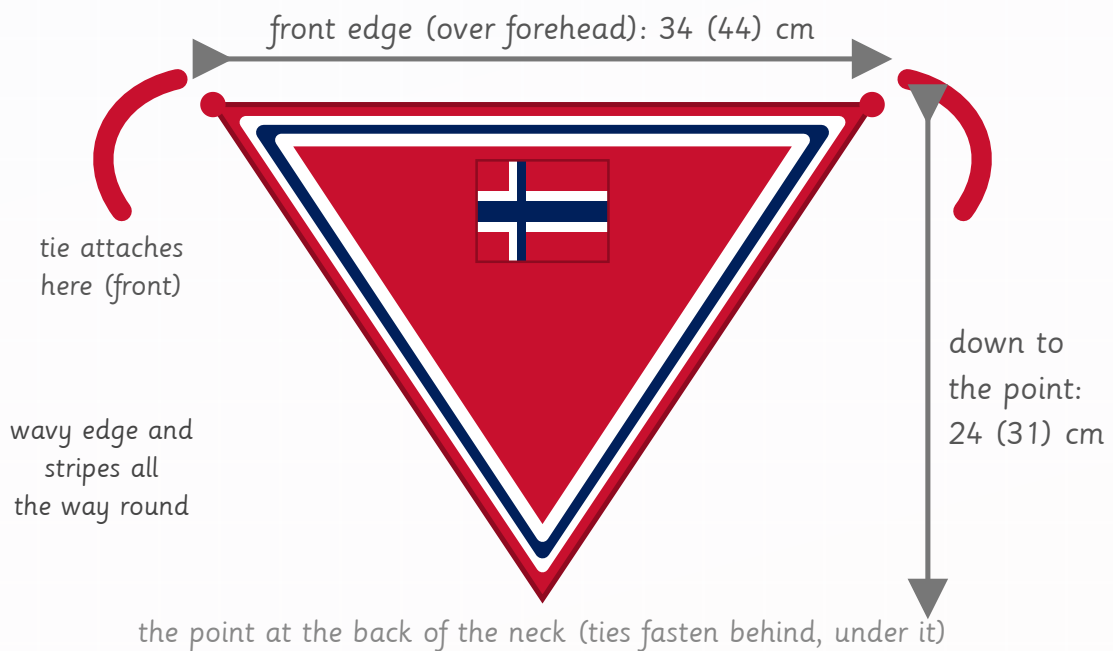
Knit a little swatch first. Cast on 20 stitches and knit garter stitch back and forth until the swatch is 10 cm tall. Lay it flat. Is 10 cm the same as 17 stitches? Then you are ready. If there are more stitches, switch to 5.5 mm needles. If there are fewer, switch to 4.5 mm needles.

SIZES AND MEASUREMENTS

HOW BIG?

The kerchief is a triangle. The wide front edge lies over the forehead. The point hangs down at the back of the neck. The ties attach at the two front corners and fasten at the back, under the point.

	Child	Adult
Front edge (over forehead)	approx. 34 cm	approx. 44 cm
Down to the point	approx. 24 cm	approx. 31 cm
Each tie	approx. 30 cm	approx. 35 cm



You can make the ties longer if you like. Then they are easy to tie.

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
st	stitch
k	knit, an ordinary stitch
row	one row, when you have knitted across and back
cast on	make the first stitches
increase	make more stitches. Here: knit 2 stitches in 1 stitch, so you get one more stitch.
bind off	take the stitches off the needle so the knitting does not unravel
I-cord	a little, round cord you knit (page 9)
float	the yarn in the colour you are not using right now, lying at the back

HOW THE KERCHIEF IS BUILT UP

- 1 The triangle:** You start at the point and increase until the triangle is big enough. If you want a flag, you knit it in the middle.
- 2 The wavy edge:** Around the whole kerchief you make a wavy edge with white and blue stripes.
- 3 The ties:** At the end you make two ties to fasten at the back of the neck.

HOW TO KNIT IN THE FLAG

You only need this page if you want the flag (the simple version skips it). You knit the flag in two colours on the same needle. You knit with red where the square is red, and with white or blue where the square is white or blue. The colour you are not using, you let hang loosely at the back. The flag chart is on page 10.

THREE THINGS TO REMEMBER

1

front



Knit each stitch in the colour the chart shows. Red is the background, white (or blue) is the pattern.

2

back



The colour you are not knitting with hangs loosely on the back. It is called a float. Keep it loose, not tight!

3

long floats



If there are more than 5 stitches between the colours, catch the long float under a stitch along the way. Then it does not hang loose.

GOOD ADVICE

- Keep the yarn at the back loose. If you pull too hard, the knitting bulges. Better too loose than too tight.
- Read each row from the bottom up, and from right to left.
- Count the squares in the chart and the stitches on the kerchief. Counting right is half the job.
- Knit a little swatch in two colours first if you like.

PART 1: THE TRIANGLE

Remember: child (adult). You knit garter stitch back and forth the whole time.

- 1 Cast on **4 stitches** in red. This is the point. It ends up at the back of the neck.
- 2 Knit 2 rows.
- 3 Now you increase. On **every 2nd row** you increase 1 stitch at each end: knit 1, increase in the next stitch, knit until 2 stitches remain, increase, knit 1. That gives 2 more stitches each time.
- 4 Keep going like this. The triangle grows bigger and bigger. Knit until the wide **front edge** measures **34 (44) cm**. That is the edge that lies over the forehead.
- 5 Want a flag? Choose where it goes. **Flag at the front:** knit it in the middle when about 5 cm remain before the wide front edge. Then the flag ends up high, over the forehead. **Flag at the back:** knit it in the middle a little after you started the triangle, while it is still narrow (about 13 to 16 stitches wide). Then the flag ends up down near the point, at the back of the neck. Follow the flag chart on page 10. If you want it simple, skip the flag.
- 6 Bind off the wide front edge loosely.

Dropped a stitch? Take it easy. Lift it back up, or ask a grown-up for help. Nothing is ruined.

PART 2: WAVY EDGE ALL AROUND

Now you make the wavy edge with flag stripes **around the whole kerchief**. The waves come from getting many stitches into a small space.

- 1 Pick up stitches with the circular needle **around the whole edge**: along the wide front edge, down one side to the point, and up the other side back. Pick up about 3 stitches for every 4 you pass. At the point and at the two front corners, pick up 1 extra so it does not pull tight.
- 2 Place a stitch marker where you started, and knit round and round. Knit 1 round in red.
- 3 Increase to **twice as many** stitches: knit 1, increase in the next, all the way around. Now the edge ripples.
- 4 Knit stripes: **2 rounds white, 2 rounds navy blue, 2 rounds white**.
- 5 Bind off loosely in red. If you pull tight, the edge stiffens. Loose gives nice waves.

SIMPLE VERSION (great for the youngest, about 8 years):

Skip the flag in Part 1. Knit just the red triangle, and make this wavy edge with the stripes. Then you never need two colours at once, only one colour at a time. Just as lovely!

PART 3: THE TIES TO FASTEN WITH

The ties are called I-cord. It is a little, round cord. It is easy to make once you know the trick.

HOW TO MAKE AN I-CORD

- 1 Cast on **3 stitches** on a double-pointed needle.
- 2 Knit 3. **Do not turn the work.**
- 3 Slide the 3 stitches to the other end of the needle. Pull the yarn tight across the back.
- 4 Knit 3 again. Repeat and repeat. Now the cord rolls up round all by itself!
- 5 Knit until the cord is **30 (35) cm**. Bind off. It needs to reach round to the neck.

ATTACH THE TIES

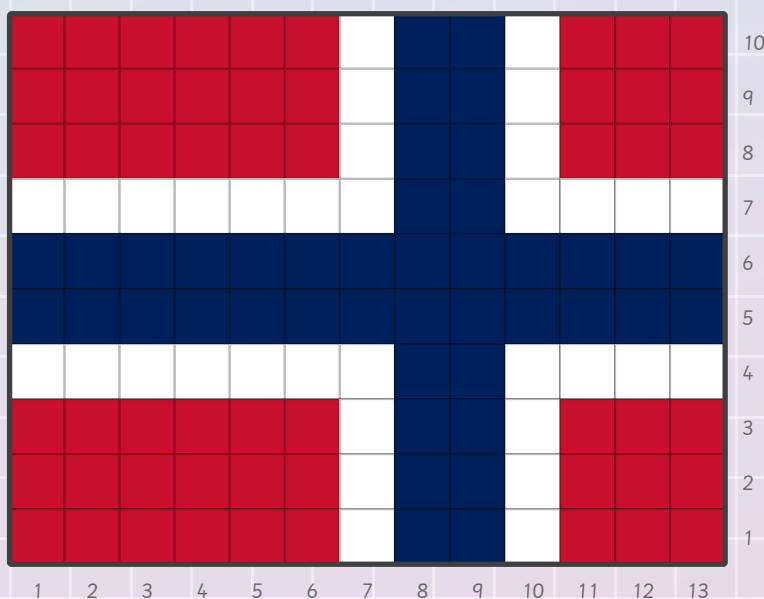
- Make **two ties**.
- Attach one tie firmly in each of the two **front corners** (where the front edge meets the sides). Sew the end fast with the tapestry needle.
- Put the kerchief on the head: the wide front edge over the forehead, the point down at the back of the neck.
- Bring the two ties round the back and tie them together **behind, under the point**.

CHART: THE FLAG

The flag is optional. If you want it, you knit it in the middle of the triangle. One square is one stitch. White square: knit with white. Blue square: knit with blue. Red square: knit with red. Read from the bottom up, from right to left. The blue line in the cross should run all the way through, unbroken.

The chart is shown upside down, because the kerchief begins at the point and is worked upwards. Knit from the chart as it appears here, and the flag will come out the right way on the finished kerchief.

THE FLAG, UPSIDE DOWN (13 SQUARES WIDE, 10 SQUARES TALL)



WHERE ON THE KERCHIEF? YOU CHOOSE

The flag always sits in the middle, between the two sides. You choose whether it goes at the front or the back:

- **Flag at the front (over the forehead):** knit the flag in when about 5 cm remain before the wide front edge. Then the triangle is wide enough, and the flag sits high up.
- **Flag at the back (near the point):** knit the flag in early, while the triangle is about 13 to 16 stitches wide. Then the flag sits down near the point, at the back of the neck.
- Either way: knit red below, above and around the flag.

FINISHING AND CARE

RIGHT AT THE END

- 1 Weave in all loose ends on the back with the tapestry needle. Trim what is left.
- 2 Rinse the kerchief in lukewarm water, or wash at 40 degrees (cotton can take it).
- 3 Squeeze out the water in a towel. Do not wring!
- 4 Lay the kerchief flat to dry. Shape the wavy edge nicely while it is wet.

CHECKLIST

- All ends are woven in
- The flag sits in the middle
- The top edge ripples
- The two ties are firmly attached

Congratulations! Now you have knitted your very own kerchief.
Wear it with the hat, go Norway!



Happy summer!

Renate Dahl · Little Montessori Explorers
lmexplorers.com